

0.0.1 Talaputa

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Rajagaha in the Bamboo Grove, at the Squirrels' Feeding Place. Then Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, said this to the Auspicious One: "This have been heard by me, O Bhante, from former comedians, Teachers of teachers, saying: "The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement." Here, what does the Auspicious One have to say about this?" "Enough Producer, leave this be. Do not ask me this."

2. Also for a second time, Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, said this to the Auspicious One: "This have been heard by me, O Bhante, from former comedians, Teachers of teachers, saying: "The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement." Here, what does the Auspicious One have to say about this?" "Enough Producer, leave this be. Do not ask me this."

3. Also for a third time, Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, said this to the Auspicious One: “This have been heard by me, O Bhante, from former comedians, Teachers of teachers, saying: “The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement.” Here, what does the Auspicious One have to say about this?”

4. Certainly, I, O Producer, could not gain your [consent] with this: “Enough Producer, leave this be. Do not ask me this.” So then, I will answer you. Beings, O Producer, who are formerly not free from lust, bounded to the bond of lust, for them a comedian at centre stage in the middle of a show draws their mind to things that are provocative of lust for increasing their lust even more. Beings, O Producer, who are formerly not free from hate, bounded to the bond of hate, for them a comedian at centre stage in the middle of a show draws their mind to things that are provocative of hate for increasing their hate even more. Beings, O Producer, who are formerly not free from delusion, bounded to the bond of delusion, for them a comedian at centre stage in the middle of a show draws their mind to things that are provocative of delusion for increasing their delusion even more. He himself being intoxicated and negligent, having caused others to be intoxicated and negligent, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises there in the hell called

amusement.

5. But if he is of such a view: “The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement,” that is wrong view. For an individual of wrong view, O Producer, his destiny is a certain one of these two destinies, I say. “Either the hell realm or the animal womb.”

6. When thus was said, Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, cried out, bursted out in tears.

7. I could not gain your [consent] with this: “Enough Producer, leave this be. Do not ask me this.”

8. I, O Bhante, am not crying because of this which the Auspicious One has said to me thus. Rather, I, O Bhante, I have been defrauded, deceived, and misled by former comedians, Teachers of teachers, saying: “The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement.”

9. “Excellent, O Bhante! Excellent, O Bhante! Just as, O Bhante, one might set upright what has been overturned, or open up what has been closed, or show a path to one who is lost, or bear an oil lamp in the darkness so that those with good eyesight can see forms, just so, O Bhante, has the Dhamma been explained by the Auspicious One in countless ways. I go, O Bhante, to the Auspicious One, as refuge, and to the Dhamma, and to the Bhikkhu Sangha. May I gain the going forth in the Auspicious One’s presence, may I obtain the higher ordination.”

10. “Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, gained the going-forth in the Auspicious One’s presence, gained the higher ordination. Not long after his higher ordination, the venerable Talaputa, dwelling alone, withdrawn, vigilant, ardent, resolute, not long entered upon and dwelled in that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life. He understood: “Destroyed is birth, lived is the life of purity, done is what had to be done, there is no other for thusness.” And the venerable Talaputa became one of the arahants.”